



Clear Credit Coach

The Credit Report Error Checklist

A printable, section-by-section checklist for reviewing your Equifax, Experian, and TransUnion reports for errors.

FREE PRINTABLE · 2026 EDITION

Step 1: Get your free reports

- 1 Go to **AnnualCreditReport.com**. It's the official site for free reports. Type the address yourself rather than clicking ads.
- 2 Request all three: **Equifax, Experian, and TransUnion**. The bureaus have permanently made free **weekly** online reports available there, according to the FTC.
- 3 **Save each report as a PDF** before you leave the page, and print a copy you can mark up.

OTHER WAYS TO ORDER

Phone: **1-877-322-8228**

Mail: Annual Credit Report Request Service, P.O. Box 105281, Atlanta, GA 30348-5281

You don't need to buy a score or monitoring product to review your reports.

WATCH FOR LOOK-ALIKE SITES

Imposter sites use similar names. The official site won't ask for a credit card to give you your free reports.

Step 2: Check every section

Each bureau may have different information, so check all three. Tick a box once a line looks correct on that bureau's report, and circle anything that looks wrong.

1. Personal information

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Name: no names or spellings you've never used (minor typos are common) | EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐ |
| ☐ Addresses: no places you've never lived | EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐ |
| ☐ Social Security number (partial) and date of birth are correct | EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐ |
| ☐ Employers and phone numbers belong to you | EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐ |

Personal information isn't used in credit scores, but unfamiliar details can be an early sign of a mixed file or identity theft.

2. Accounts (tradelines)

- ☐ **Accounts not yours:** you recognize every creditor and account EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Ownership:** listed correctly as individual, joint, or authorized user EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Balances** match your most recent statements (paid accounts show \$0) EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Credit limits / high balances** are correct and not missing EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Dates** (opened, last payment, closed) are correct EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Payment history:** no late marks for months you paid on time EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Status:** no closed accounts shown as open (or open shown as closed), and paid accounts aren't shown as unpaid EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ **Duplicates:** the same debt isn't listed twice with a balance EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐

3. Collections

- ☐ You recognize the collector and the original creditor EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ The balance is correct, and paid collections show as paid EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ The original creditor and the collector aren't *both* showing a balance for the same debt EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ The date of first delinquency looks right. Most negative items can be reported for up to 7 years. EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ Medical collections: under bureau policy, paid medical collections and those under \$500 generally aren't reported EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐

4. Inquiries

- ☐ You recognize every **hard** inquiry, meaning you applied for that credit EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ There are no inquiries from lenders you've never contacted EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ Soft inquiries (account reviews, your own checks) are normal and don't need action EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐

5. Public records

- ☐ Any bankruptcy shown is yours, with the correct chapter and dates EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ Accounts that were discharged in bankruptcy are marked that way and show a \$0 balance EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ Chapter 7 bankruptcies may be reported for up to 10 years. Look for anything older than that. EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐

6. Mixed files & identity theft signs

- ☐ Several unfamiliar items seem to belong to **one other person** (for example, a relative or someone with a similar name) EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ There are new accounts or applications you didn't make EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ Bills, collection calls, or mail about debts you don't recognize EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐
- ☐ If you suspect identity theft, report it at **IdentityTheft.gov** and consider a free fraud alert or security freeze EQ ☐ EX ☐ TU ☐

My notes: items to look into

Bureau	Company & last 4 digits	What looks wrong	My proof

Step 3: What to do if you find an error

General information only, not legal advice. The federal Fair Credit Reporting Act gives you the right to dispute information you believe is inaccurate or incomplete, for free.

- 1 Confirm it's really an error.** Compare it with your own statements, receipts, or letters. Accurate, timely information can legally stay on your report, so disputes are for information that is inaccurate, incomplete, or can't be verified.
- 2 Dispute directly, yourself.** You can dispute with the **credit bureau** showing the error (online, by mail, or by phone), and/or with the **company that reported it** (the "furnisher"). Say clearly what's wrong, why, and include copies of supporting documents.
- 3 Keep copies of everything:** letters, enclosures, confirmation numbers, and certified mail receipts. Write down dates.
- 4 Know the general timeline.** Bureaus generally have about **30 days** to investigate a dispute. In some situations, such as when you send additional information, it can be up to 45 days. You should then receive the results in writing.

WANT THE FULL STEP-BY-STEP?

The Do-It-Yourself Credit Report Guide (\$49) walks you through reading each section of a report, your dispute rights in plain English, bureau addresses and mailing tips, 10 fill-in-the-blank letter templates (PDF + Word), and a printable dispute tracker. It's all education, so you handle everything yourself.

Learn more: clearcoach.gumroad.com/l/diy-credit-guide

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